



WHERE THE MONEY ACTUALLY IS

The system is the barrier. The refill is the business. Attention has been going to neither.

Systems go out close to cost, and the margin arrives later at roughly **\$70 gross a keg**. That makes this a subscription business wearing a brewery’s clothes. A subscription business needs people to stay home and reorder. The Tap Room needs them to come in. Eighteen months of attention went to the half that loses money.

The fix is not optimisation, it is reshaping. Running a brewery and a hospitality venue on a skeleton staff is not a resourcing problem to be solved with more hours.

Reshaping means three concrete things: the room stops being staffed for walk-in trade it does not get, the spend that was chasing footfall moves to refills and wholesale, and somebody owns wholesale as a job rather than as an evening.

Per-keg margin and system economics from the Discovery pack. Test them against the current P&L before the plan is signed.

THE FOUR UNITS, AND THE CALL ON EACH

UNIT	TODAY	THE CALL
Refills	96–113 active, at MVP, reached with no push	Scale. This is the business
Tap Room	Walk-in trade does not cover it. Events already do	Pivot. Destination, not walk-in
Wholesale	Approaches come in, nothing converts	Resource. A role with targets
Canning	Not started. Opens bottle shops and bars	Decide. See the box below

The Tap Room is not being closed. It is being asked to earn its keep a different way.

THE CLIMB TO 1,000

206

SYSTEMS IN THE DATABASE NOW

~9×

MULTIPLE NEEDED TO HIT 1,000

116

OWNERS WHO BOUGHT ELSEWHERE

The cheapest growth is the 116 who already own a system and already refill here. Their objections are overcome. Nobody has to be sold on the idea of beer at home.

Partners move this number, campaigns do not. Harvey Norman, Kegland and Benchy each put Tap That in front of people who have already bought the hardware.

A nine-times climb is not a marketing target, it is a distribution target. It needs partners, not posts.

UNIT ECONOMICS, AND THE ARGUMENT

One wholesale account is worth about ten households. That ratio is the whole case for resourcing wholesale ahead of another consumer campaign.

Members leak at 18%, non-members at 44%. Attaching membership to a system sale is the single highest-return retention move available.

The story is cost per schooner at home against a pub schooner at \$12 to \$18. Not sticker price on a keg.

63% of customers said they would host a demo at their own place. That is a distribution channel sitting unused, and it costs nothing but coordination.

Two membership programmes are running against one business. If the room becomes a destination and refills lead, one of them is paying for a shape the business no longer has. Redesign both around the refill, or drop one.

The at-home per-schooner figure is not settled. Three different sets of maths are in circulation and one is on a live ad. Settle it before it goes in any collateral.

THE CANNING QUESTION

Christy raised it. Tap That pushed back. No decision was taken.

For: a bottle shop is where people who drink beer find out the brand exists at all, which no amount of keg marketing reaches. It also opens bars and restaurants that will not give up a tap, and shipping cans goes further than shipping kegs.

Against: low margin, high effort, and it competes directly with the refill model this plan is built on. Tap That has already priced a small line at eight cans a minute and parked it, on the grounds that it adds a thing to a business that is not yet nailing the things it has.

What would settle it: a costed run through the cannery contact next door, priced against Earth Brew at about \$36 a four-pack. Premium small batch, not a price fight.

Worth revisiting if walk-in trade is wound back and a new awareness channel is needed.

DECISIONS REQUIRED

- **Pause walk-in trading?** Owner: Justin. The rest of the plan assumes yes.
- **Fund a wholesale role?** Full-timer or commissioned agent, with KPIs either way.
- **Attach membership to every system sale?** Retention maths says yes.
- **Commission the canning feasibility?** A number, not an opinion.
- **Settle the per-schooner figure.** Then pull or correct the live ad.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

- **Pausing walk-ins costs community.** The room built the ambassadors. Replace it with systems before it goes, not after.
- **Wholesale hire without a process.** A salesperson with no CRM behind them will fail the same way the founders did.
- **Cutting the range too fast.** The tail costs money, but some of it is why people come.
- **Everything at once.** The recurring failure has been starting things and moving on. Three moves finished beats ten started.

Justin’s own point in the catch-up: as this scales, the personal connection cannot hold. It has to be replicated in systems.